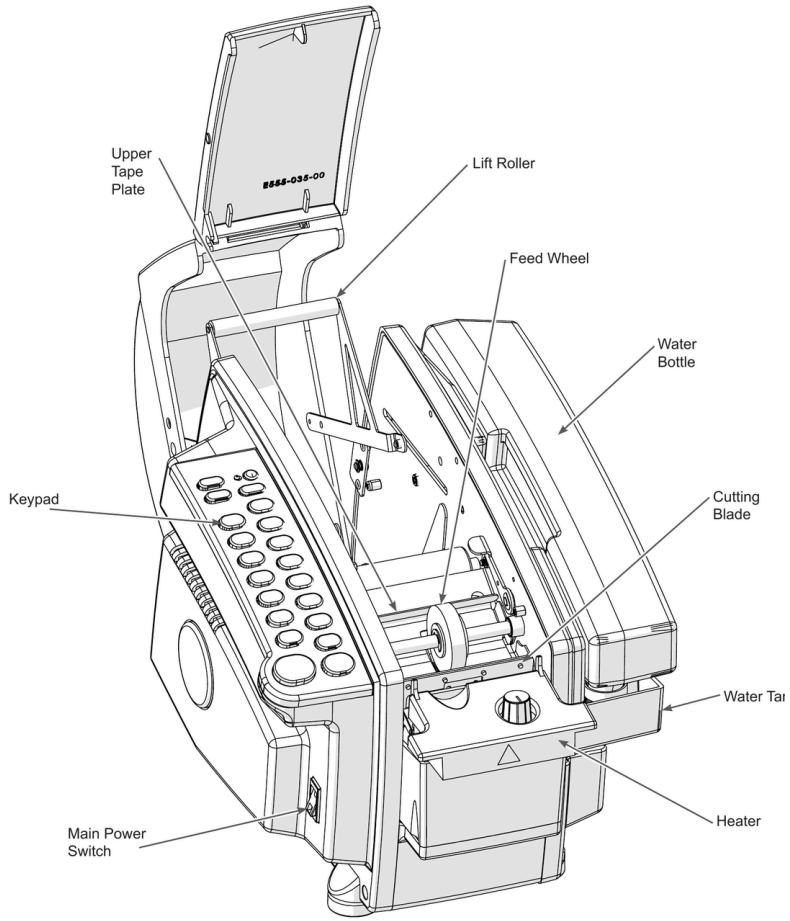
Running the BP555

Operator training for the Better Pack 555e gummed tape dispenser. Set it up, use every button, program Automatic Mode and seal a carton properly.



Supplied by **Cotswold Packaging Group**
Based on the Better Packages 555e User Manual, Rev 3.1

What's where on the machine



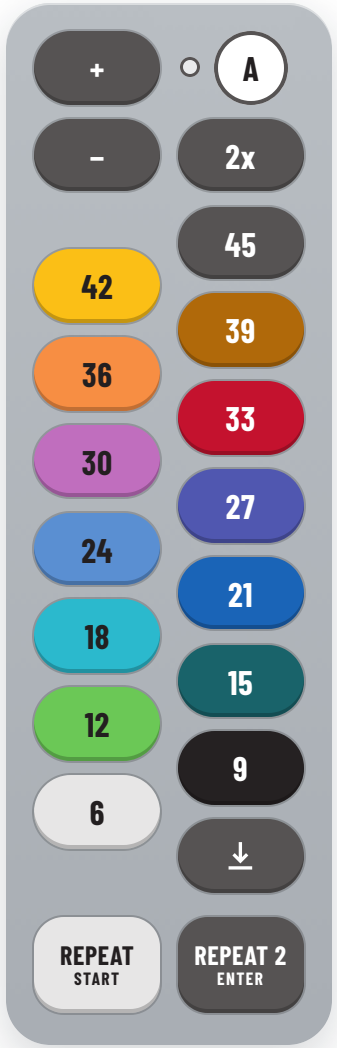
Lid open. Drawing from the 555e manual, Figure 10.

You only touch four things in normal use.

KEYPAD	Top left. Chooses the tape length and the mode.
MAIN POWER SWITCH	Lower front, right side. **I** is on, **O** is off.
HEATER CONTROL DIAL	Knob on top of the heater, above the water tank. OFF to MAX.
WATER LEVEL SLIDER	On the right side of the water tank. Sets how wet the tape gets.

The lid has a safety switch. The machine will not feed tape unless the lid is fully closed and sitting square.

The keypad at a glance



ADJUST + adds half an inch (13 mm), – takes it off, 2x doubles. Press these **before** the length.

LENGTHS 14 colour-coded buttons, 6 to 45 inches. Press one and it feeds straight out.

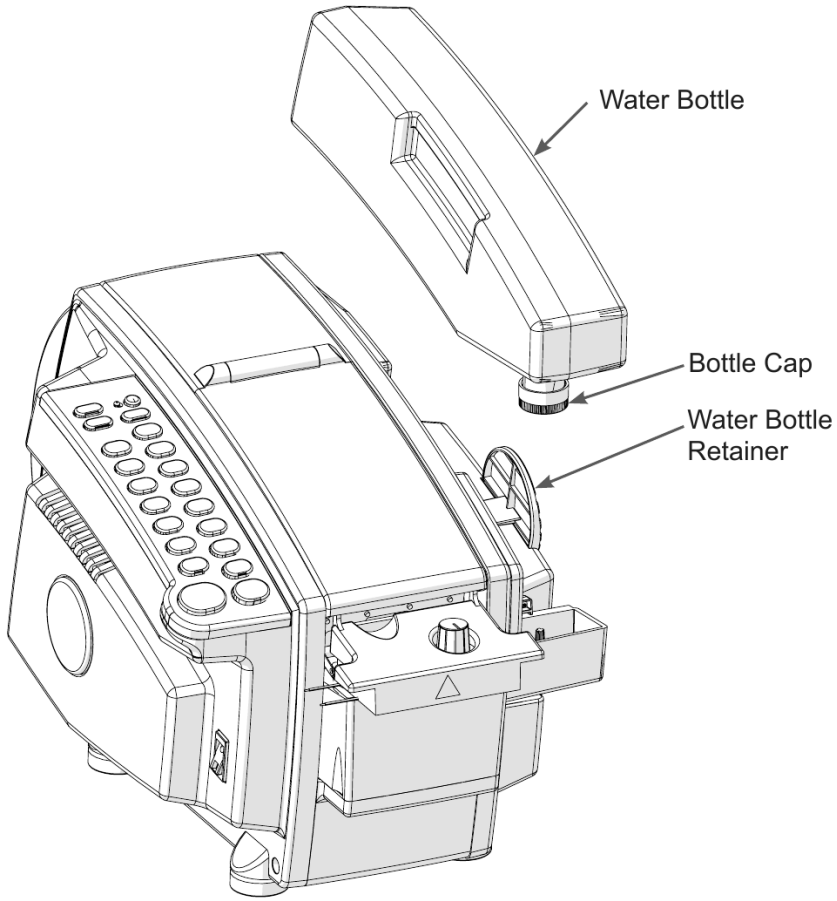
REPEAT REPEAT START the last length again. REPEAT 2 ENTER the one before.

RANDOM ↓ feeds tape while you hold it.

AUTOMATIC A turns Automatic Mode on and off. Red light means on.

Standard models have no A or REPEAT 2 ENTER. Metric models show centimetres on the same buttons.

Get ready 1: fill the water bottle

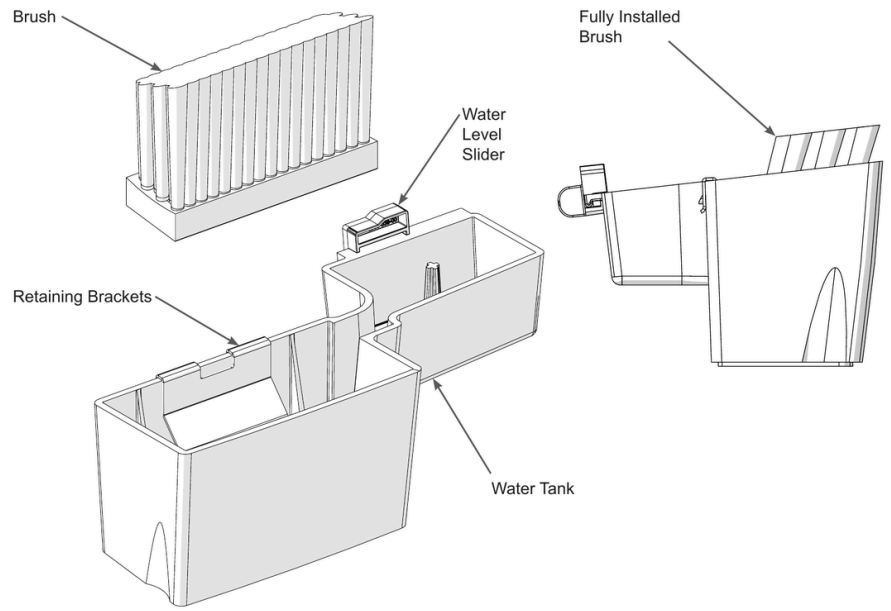


Manual, Figure 21.

1. Unscrew the cap and fill the 1.8 litre bottle with room-temperature tap water.
2. Screw the cap back on tightly. The membrane in the cap seals the bottle.
3. Put the bottle on its shelf with the indent under the water bottle retainer.
4. Check the cap sits around the post in the water tank. Water flows in and stops by itself once it reaches the cap.

No special water needed. If your site has hard water, use filtered water to make the brush and cap seal last longer.

Get ready 2: brush and water level

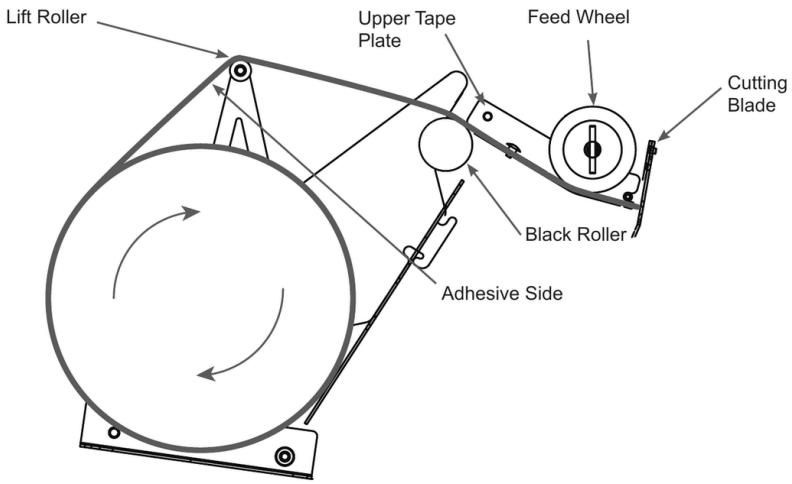


Manual, Figure 19.

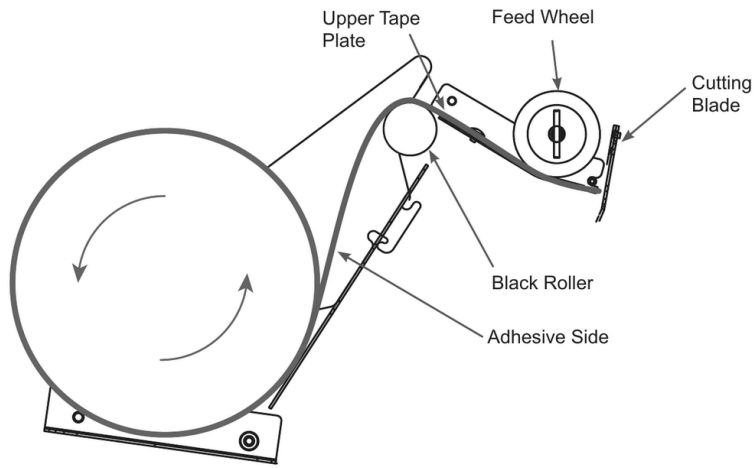
1. Turn the brush so the shortest bristles face the machine.
2. Drop it into the opening against the retaining bracket and press down until the bracket grips it.
3. Check the bristles lie flat across the top of the tank.
4. Slide the tank in under the heater until it locks onto the shelf.
5. Set the **Water Level Slider**: towards the machine for more water, away for less.

Hot heater. The underside of the heater gets hot. Lift it only by the grip tabs on each side.

Get ready 3: load the tape



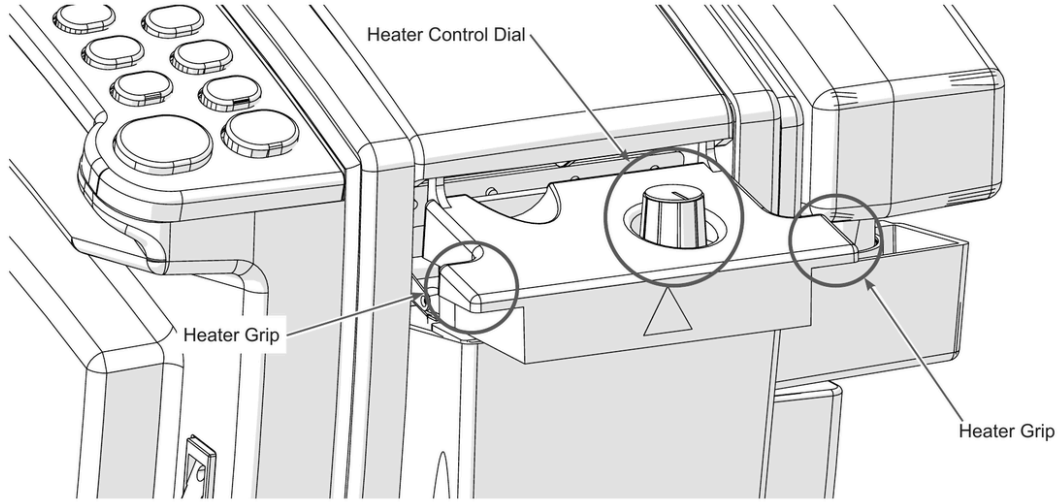
`eS eSA eL eFA eFACM eJ eJA` Gum side in



`eM eMA` Gum side out

1. Open the lid and cut the tape end square with scissors.
2. Stand the roll upright. The end comes from under the roll: over the back for gum side in, up the front for gum side out.
3. Feed it over the rollers, under the upper tape plate and feed wheel, up to the blade. Close the lid.

Switch on and set the heat



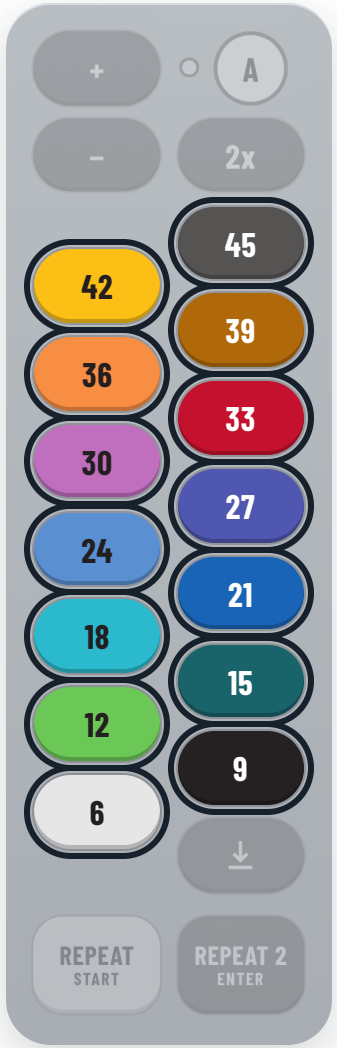
Manual, Figure 23.

1. Flip the **Main Power Switch** to **I**.
2. Wait for the beep. That means the machine has started up and is ready.
3. Turn the **Heater Control Dial** from OFF towards MAX. It has five dots in between. It leaves the factory set to OFF.

In a heated or climate-controlled building you will not need more than halfway. Keeping it lower makes the heater last longer.

Allow at least 30 minutes for the heater to cool before you touch its underside.

Feed a length of tape



Press a coloured number. That length feeds out straight away, wet and cut, ready to tear off.

BUTTONS 6 9 12 15 18 21 24 and on up to 45 inches, in two columns.

SPEED 45 inches (114 cm) a second.

FULL RANGE With + , − and 2x you can get anything from 4 to 120 inches (102 to 3048 mm), in half-inch steps.

`eL` long models run 12 to 90 inches. `eM eMA eJ eJA` metric models run 15 to 145 cm.

Make it longer or shorter

Press the adjustment first, then the length. The length button is what makes the tape come out.

> **Pressing [+] after the number is too late.** That piece has already been cut.

PRESS	YOU GET
[+] → [24]	**24.5 in** half an inch longer
[+] → [+] → [24]	**25 in** one inch longer
[−] → [24]	**23.5 in** half an inch shorter
[−] → [−] → [24]	**23 in** one inch shorter
[2x] → [24]	**48 in** doubled
[+] → [+] → [+] → [2x] → [24]	**49.5 in** doubled, then 1.5 in added

Repeat a length, or feed by hand

REPEAT
START

Same again

Feeds the last length you dispensed. Use it when you are sealing a run of the same carton.

REPEAT 2
ENTER

The one before

Feeds the second-to-last length. Handy when you alternate between two sizes.

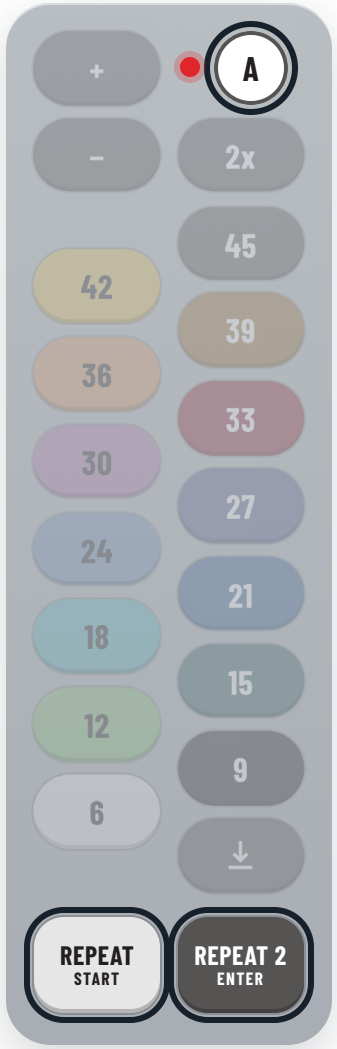
`Automatic models only`



Hold to feed

Tape keeps coming for as long as you hold the button down. Let go and it stops. Use it for an odd length you do not have a button for.

Automatic Mode: tape ready before you reach for it



You store up to three lengths. Each time you tear a piece off, the next one feeds out by itself, and the sequence loops.

TURN ON Press (A). You hear a beep and the light next to it glows red.

STORE REPEAT 2 ENTER saves the length you just dispensed.

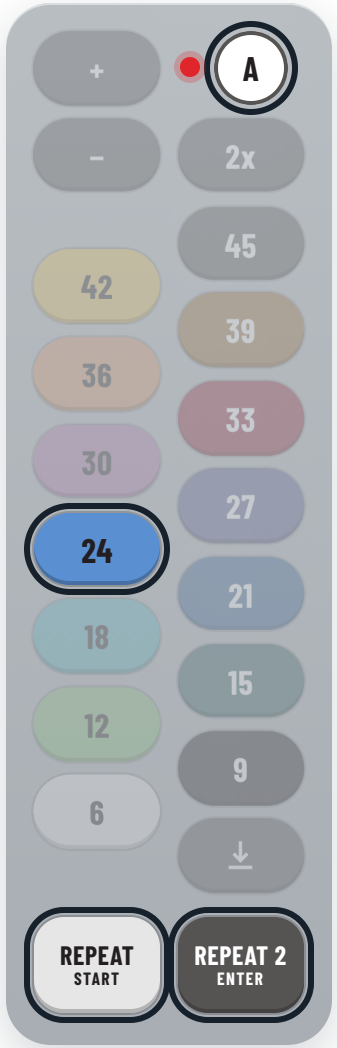
RUN REPEAT START starts the stored sequence.

TURN OFF Press (A) again, or switch the machine off.

> **Turning off clears the program.** Pressing (A) or switching off at the Main Power Switch wipes the stored lengths. You will need to program them again.

`eSA eLA eMA eFA eJA` automatic models only.

Program one length

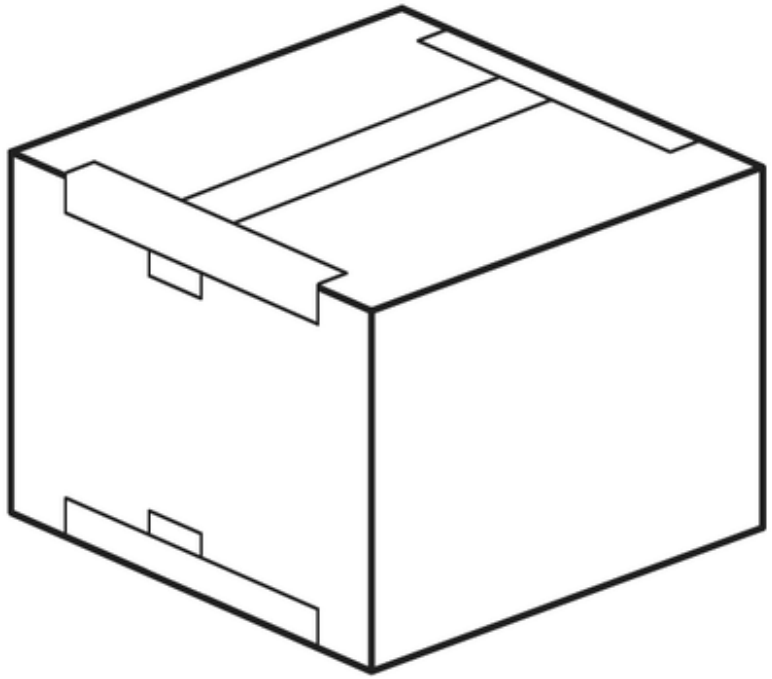


1. Press (A). Beep, red light on.
2. Press 24. A 24 inch piece feeds out. Tear it off and put it on the carton.
3. Press REPEAT 2 ENTER to store that length.
4. Press REPEAT START to run the program.

The machine feeds a 24 inch piece. Tear it off and the next one feeds straight out, every time, until you press (A) again.

You can store an adjusted length too. Use +, –, 2x or ↓ as normal before you press REPEAT 2 ENTER.

Program an H pattern: three lengths



The H pattern seals the centre seam plus both ends. It adds strength for heavy or fragile goods, storage and export.

1. Press **A**.
2. Press **24**, tear off and apply. Press **REPEAT 2 ENTER**.
3. Press **6**, tear off and apply. Press **REPEAT 2 ENTER**.
4. Press **6**, tear off and apply. Press **REPEAT 2 ENTER**.
5. Press **REPEAT START**.

The machine now feeds 24, then 6, then 6, then starts again at 24. Each piece comes out when you remove the last one. Swap in your own carton's lengths.

How long should the tape be?

Measure the seam, then add enough for a leg of tape down each end of the carton.

CARTON	ADD TO THE SEAM LENGTH
Most cartons	**4 to 6 in** 100 to 150 mm
Very long cartons	**6 to 8 in** 150 to 200 mm
Short cartons	**3 to 4 in** 75 to 100 mm

Choosing the tape

PAPER TAPE Kraft paper only. Good for smaller, lighter cartons.

REINFORCED Paper with reinforcing strands, usually fibreglass. For larger and heavier cartons.

Takes tape 1.5 to 3 inches (38 to 76 mm) wide, on rolls up to 10 inches (254 mm) across and 1000 feet (305 m) long.

Is the tape wet enough?

Just right

- Evenly wet, no dry patches
- No water running off
- Glue feels oily and moves under your finger
- Press two wet pieces together and pull apart: you see strings of glue, like pulled toffee

Too wet

- Takes too long to set
- Can slide on the carton and leave a loose seal

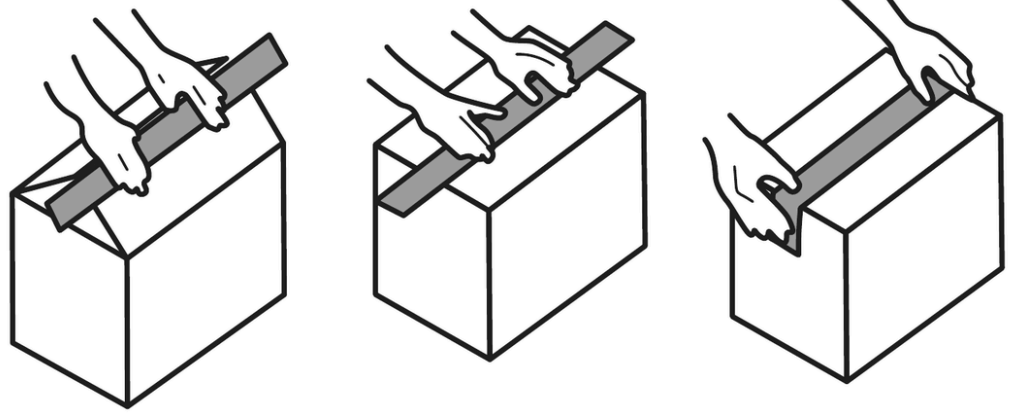
Slide the **Water Level Slider** away from the machine.

Too dry

- Feels tacky like sticky tape, not oily
- Glue cannot soak into the board, so no permanent bond
- Can peel off in transit

Slide the **Water Level Slider** towards the machine, check the bottle and clean the brush.

Seal the carton



Manual, Figure 27.

1. Lay the wet tape along the edge of one flap: half on the flap, half hanging over.
2. Fold the other flap down.
3. Fold the taped flap down so the overhang lands on the other flap.
4. Press lightly from the middle out to the sides, then down over the ends. A second wipe before you let go helps.

Quick fixes

NO TAPE Check the power cord is in, the **Main Power Switch** is on **I**, and the lid is fully closed and square. The lid safety switch stops the machine when it is open.

NO BEEP If there is no beep when you switch on at a working socket, call for service.

TAPE JAMS Check the upper tape plate is in place. Without it the tape jams. Make sure the tape path is clean and dry.

DRY TAPE Slide the **Water Level Slider** towards the machine. Refill the bottle. Wash the brush.

WRONG LENGTH If every piece is too long or too short, the feed wheel needs adjusting. That is a job for your maintenance person.

HANDS STICKY The glue is non-toxic and water soluble. Soap and water takes it off.

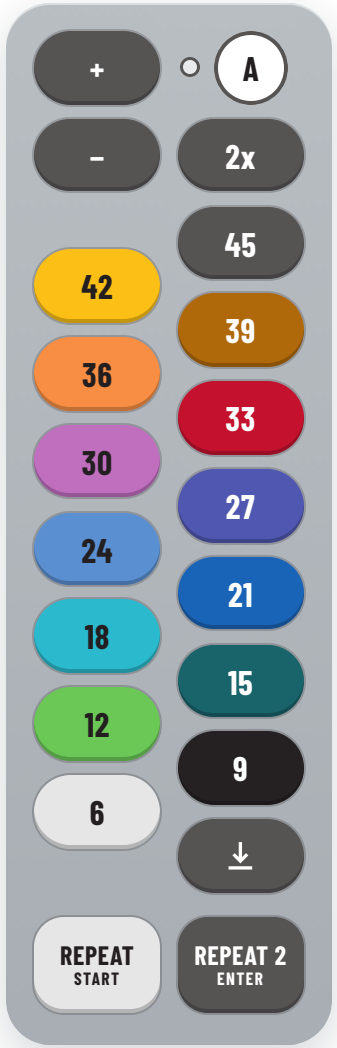
End of the shift

1. Flip the **Main Power Switch** to **O**.
2. Leave the heater alone for at least 30 minutes before touching it.
3. Top up the water bottle if it is low, ready for the next shift.

Switching off clears Automatic Mode. Any stored lengths are gone. Program them again when you switch back on.

Wash the brush, water tank and bottle once a week. The cleaning deck and cleaning card show every step.

Recap



1. Fill the bottle, fit the brush and tank, set the **Water Level Slider**.
2. Load the tape to the blade and close the lid.
3. **Main Power Switch** to **I**, wait for the beep, set the heater.
4. Press a length. Adjust with + − 2x first, then the length.
5. REPEAT START for the same again, hold ↓ for odd lengths.
6. A then length, REPEAT 2 ENTER, REPEAT START to run Automatic Mode.

Questions or a demo for another site: **Jo Lavene, Cotswold Packaging Group, 07930 404517**